Q. What were the biggest lessons of Operation Sindoor?
One strategic lesson is that nations today increasingly find it easier to use force because technology allows highly precise strikes with limited collateral damage. Earlier, there was greater hesitation because war meant large-scale destruction and civilian casualties. Precision warfare has altered that calculation. But while countries may know how to start conflicts, many still struggle with understanding when and how to stop. In Sindoor, we won because we understood when to do so. One important aspect of our own operations was that we knew how to calibrate the use of force at the appropriate time and when to disengage.

Q. Why do you think India won Sindoor decisively?
A tremendous amount of preparation went into the operation before the first strike. Intelligence agencies, military intelligence and operational planners were continuously updating target information because terrorist elements were shifting locations. Precise geospatial targeting data was prepared for every strike. Resources were repositioned from the eastern sector, air assets were moved and forces mobilised. India's intention from the beginning was clear: conduct precise punitive strikes on terror targets, demonstrate capability and avoid unnecessary escalation. We were able to do that because we had better networks and superior situational awareness. We knew what we had hit, what effect it had created, and we knew when Pakistani strikes had been neutralised. That gave us escalation control. We could escalate or de-escalate at will because we understood the battlefield better than the adversary.

Q. How did India achieve escalation dominance during Sindoor?
We disrupted Pakistan's radar systems heavily through our strikes. These attacks created major dilemmas for their air defence network. They had to switch off many of their radars to avoid being targeted by us. Pakistan became blind. That opened operational corridors for Indian strikes deep inside Pakistan. Pakistan believed many of its strikes had succeeded because it lacked accurate battle damage assessment. In fact, after the operation, they were reportedly trying to source imagery from open sources and foreign providers because they did not have clarity on the actual effects. That informational superiority gave us the operational edge. By the time they initiated contact for talks, they realised India retained escalation dominance. That was one of the principal reasons why they sought an immediate ceasefire. Pakistan had expected operations to continue for a much longer duration, but within a far shorter period, they realised they were being hit at strategic depths and that they did not possess a clear understanding of the operational picture.

Q. Pakistan claimed India suffered losses. Is that true?
No war is entirely one-sided. There are some losses in every conflict. But losses matter only if they affect morale or reduce operational capability. In our case, they did not. None of it impacted us in a way that would deter us. Indian operations continued aggressively—aircraft kept flying, strikes continued and the operational tempo remained high. Pakistan, on the other hand, could not fly as it increasingly relied on ground-launched systems. India conducted offensive air operations throughout till cessation of hostilities was announced.



"While countries know how to start conflicts, many do not know when and how to stop. In Sindoor, we won because we knew when to use force and when to disengage"

"Our strikes disrupted Pakistan's radar system, leaving its forces blind. This opened operational corridors for India to strike deep inside Pakistan, giving us escalation dominance"

Q. Was there concern that Pakistan would resort to nuclear escalation?
No such signalling was observed from Pakistan during the operation. India's doctrine remains based on two pillars—No First Use and massive retaliation. Ironically, that doctrine creates greater space for conventional military operations because Pakistan knows that if they resorted to even one tactical nuclear attack, we would respond with massive retaliation across its territory. We have sent them strong messaging that